Retention for report exports

Status: proposed

Context

The export worker writes each report export to object storage as a CSV file.

Nothing deletes them, so storage holds every export since launch.

Requirements

R1. An export is deleted when its retention period ends.

The period depends on the account plan, as the table below gives it.

R2. A customer can download an export until it is deleted.

R3. Every deletion is written to the audit log before the export is removed.

Plan Retention

Free 30 days

Team 90 days

Enterprise 365 days

Design

A nightly sweep selects the exports whose retention period has ended.

For each, it writes an audit entry, deletes the object, then deletes the row.

A row whose object is already gone is deleted without an error.

So a sweep that stops partway and runs again leaves the same state.

Enterprise exports are kept for 90 days, the same as Team.

So the sweep needs only two retention periods.

The sweep skips every account with a legal hold.

Alternatives considered

Object storage lifecycle rules, which expire objects by age. Rejected.

Rollout

The sweep ships disabled behind the export_retention setting.

It runs one week in report-only mode, logging what it would delete.

Then it is enabled for deletion; turning the setting off stops it.

Open questions

Should a deleted export stay recoverable for 7 days in a holding bucket?

This decides whether the sweep deletes objects or moves them.